

# The Apostles that Turned?

## Authoritarian Successor Parties and Democratic Backsliding

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# The Puzzle

- Authoritarian successor parties (ASPs) often credited with **stabilizing** young democracies
- **Optimistic account:** reinvented ASPs anchor democratic party systems Grzymala-Busse (2002, 2020); Miller (2021); Loxton & Mainwaring (2018); Riedl (2014)
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# Argument: When Apostles Bite Back

- ASPs are vote-seeking organizations: survival drives behavior
- Electoral decline does not always produce dissolution; it can produce adaptation/resistance
- When cornered, they revert to anti-pluralism: dog-whistling, anti-pluralism, and most importantly alliances with populists

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- ASP: electoral declines → Anti-pluralism → backsliding
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# Empirical Strategy (Quantitative Context + BPT)

- **Cross-national:** Cox PH models (empirical scope calibration)
  - ▶ Data: Grzymala-Busse (2020) × V-Party × ERT × V-Dem
  - ▶ 81 countries, 1945–2015
- **Within-case:** Bayesian Process Tracing of South Korea
  - ▶ suitable for testing sequential arguments
  - ▶ simple posterior updating using Bayes' Theorem based on evidentiary pieces

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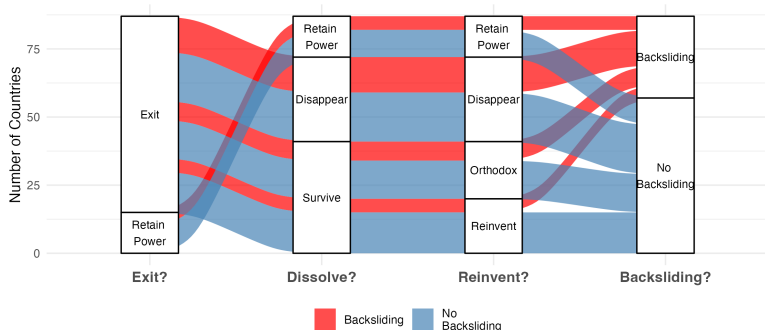
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# ASP Fate and Backsliding: Descriptive



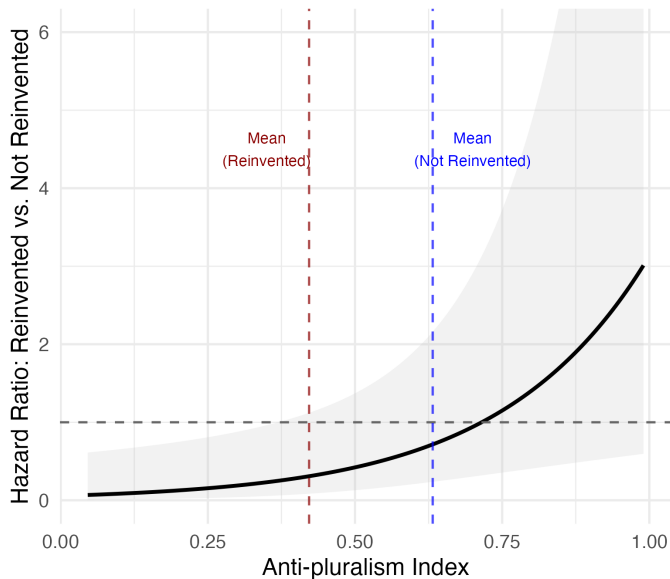
- Reinvented ASPs: minority of cases, non-negligible share of backsliding

# Cox PH Estimates

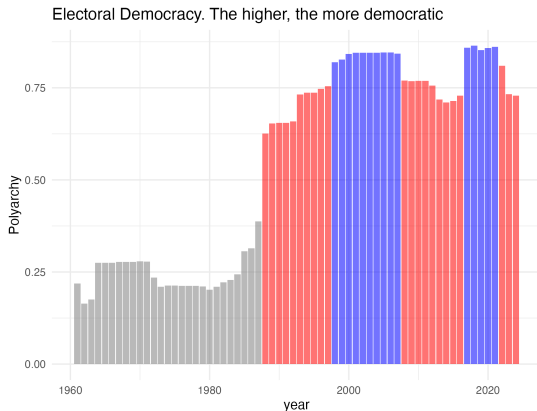
|                                | <b>Model 1</b><br>Baseline | <b>Model 2</b><br>Controls |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| Reinvented                     | 0.057**<br>[0.005, 0.656]  | 0.095*<br>[0.006, 1.446]   |
| Anti-pluralism                 | 0.479<br>[0.060, 3.800]    | 0.593<br>[0.048, 7.384]    |
| Reinvented $\times$ Anti-plur. | 55.14**<br>[1.72, 1768]    | 192.51**<br>[2.92, 12706]  |
| Polyarchy                      |                            | 0.353<br>[0.011, 11.3]     |
| ln(GDP per capita)             |                            | 0.419*<br>[0.249, 0.708]   |
| Num. Obs.                      | 539                        | 539                        |
| Concordance                    | 0.703                      | 0.769                      |

Hazard ratios with 95% CI in brackets. SEs clustered by country.

# Conditional Effect



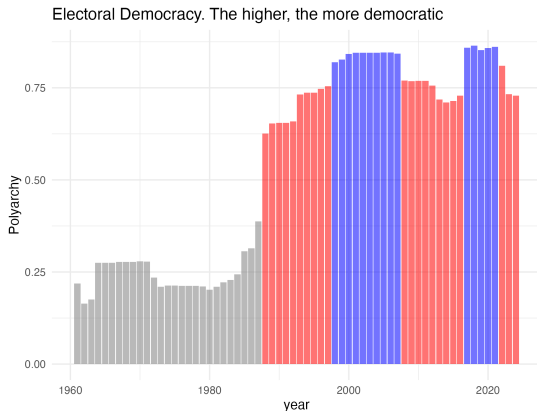
# Case: South Korea



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# Hypotheses and Priors

| Hypothesis                                                 | Prior | Justification                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| H (Apostle)                                                | 0.3   | <i>Moderate</i> cross-national support                          |
| A <sub>1</sub> (Demand-side:<br>'people wanted it')        | 0.35  | Fairly strong support from comparative behavioral literature    |
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# Summary of Evidential Tests

| OI                                                                                     | Test Type               | Hs              | Predicted Evidence                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <b><i>H<sub>1</sub>: Electoral Decline → Anti-pluralist Turn</i></b>                   |                         |                 |                                            |
| Ol <sub>1</sub>                                                                        | Hoop                    | H <sub>1</sub>  | right sequence                             |
| Ol <sub>2</sub>                                                                        | Smoking Gun             | H <sub>1</sub>  | evidence of adopting anti-pluralism        |
| <b><i>H<sub>2</sub>: Anti-pluralistic Turn → Facilitation of Populist Outsider</i></b> |                         |                 |                                            |
| Ol <sub>3</sub>                                                                        | Hoop                    | H <sub>2</sub>  | right sequence                             |
| Ol <sub>4</sub>                                                                        | Smoking Gun             | H <sub>2</sub>  | Outsider's reliance on ASP                 |
| <b><i>H<sub>3</sub>: Alliance → Executive Aggrandizement</i></b>                       |                         |                 |                                            |
| Ol <sub>5</sub>                                                                        | Hoop                    | H <sub>3</sub>  | institutional 'necessary condition'        |
| Ol <sub>6</sub>                                                                        | Smoking Gun             | H <sub>3</sub>  | specific legislation/institutional support |
| <b><i>Alternative Hypotheses</i></b>                                                   |                         |                 |                                            |
| Ol <sub>A1a</sub>                                                                      | Hoop for A <sub>1</sub> | !A <sub>1</sub> | right sequence                             |
| Ol <sub>A1b</sub>                                                                      | Discriminating          | !A <sub>1</sub> | no causal reversal                         |
| Ol <sub>A2</sub>                                                                       | Discriminating          | !A <sub>2</sub> | Non-ASP govt, no backsliding               |

# Evidential Test (OI<sub>1</sub>): South Korean Election Results

| Year | Legislative Election Winner     | Seat Share<br>(Winning Party<br>%) | Presidential<br>Election Winner |
|------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 1987 |                                 |                                    |                                 |
| 1988 | <i>Democratic Justice Party</i> | 125/299 (41.8)                     | <i>Kim Young-sam</i>            |
| 1992 | <i>Democratic Liberal Party</i> | 149/299 (49.8)                     |                                 |
| 1996 | <i>New Korea Party</i>          | 139/299 (46.5)                     |                                 |
| 1997 |                                 |                                    | Kim Dae-jung                    |
| 2000 | <i>Grand National Party</i>     | 133/273 (48.7)                     | Roh Moo-hyun                    |
| 2002 |                                 |                                    |                                 |
| 2004 | Uri Party                       | 152/299 (50.8)                     | <i>Lee Myung-bak</i>            |
| 2007 |                                 |                                    |                                 |
| 2008 | <i>Grand National Party</i>     | 153/299 (51.2)                     | <i>Park Geun-hye</i>            |
| 2012 | <i>Saenuri Party</i>            | 152/300 (50.7)                     |                                 |
| 2016 | Democratic Party of Korea       | 123/300 (41.0)                     | Moon Jae-in                     |
| 2017 |                                 |                                    |                                 |
| 2020 | Democratic Party of Korea       | 180/300 (60.0)                     | <i>Yoon Suk-yeol</i>            |
| 2022 |                                 |                                    |                                 |
| 2024 | Democratic Party of Korea       | 175/300 (58.3)                     |                                 |

# Likelihood Assignments

- Clear support: anti-pluralism did NOT precede electoral declines.
- Fair support: electoral declines preceded anti-pluralism.
- 'higher-than-random but not too high' chance for  $H_1$

| <b>Ol</b>         | <b><math>P(E   H)</math></b> | <b><math>P(E   A_1)</math></b> | <b><math>P(E   A_2)</math></b> |
|-------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Ol <sub>1</sub>   | 0.75                         | 0.5                            | 0.5                            |
| Ol <sub>2</sub>   |                              |                                |                                |
| Ol <sub>3</sub>   |                              |                                |                                |
| Ol <sub>4</sub>   |                              |                                |                                |
| Ol <sub>5</sub>   |                              |                                |                                |
| Ol <sub>6</sub>   |                              |                                |                                |
| Ol <sub>A1a</sub> |                              |                                |                                |
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| Ol <sub>A1b</sub> |            |              |              |
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# Calculate normalized posterior using Bayes Rule

$$\begin{aligned} P(H | E) &= \frac{P(E | H) P(H)}{P(E | H) P(H) + P(E | A_1) P(A_1) + P(E | A_2) P(A_2)} \\ &= \frac{(0.75)(0.30)}{(0.75)(0.30) + (0.50)(0.35) + (0.50)(0.35)} \\ &= \frac{0.225}{0.575} \approx 0.391 \end{aligned}$$



# Posterior Probabilities

| Step         | $P(H \mid E)$ | $P(A_1 \mid E)$ | $P(A_2 \mid E)$ |
|--------------|---------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| <i>Prior</i> | <i>0.30</i>   | <i>0.35</i>     | <i>0.35</i>     |
| $Ol_1$       | 0.391         | 0.304           | 0.304           |
| $Ol_2$       |               |                 |                 |
| $Ol_3$       |               |                 |                 |
| $Ol_4$       |               |                 |                 |
| $Ol_5$       |               |                 |                 |
| $Ol_6$       |               |                 |                 |
| $Ol_{A1a}$   |               |                 |                 |
| $Ol_{A1b}$   |               |                 |                 |
| $Ol_{A2}$    |               |                 |                 |

# Contribution

- Reconceptualizes ASPs as **conditionally** destabilizing
- Integrates party-level dynamics into backsliding theory
- Bridges two bodies of literature that have developed in isolation:
  - ▶ ASP / democratic consolidation
  - ▶ Contemporary democratic backsliding
- Policy implication: the most effective democratic gatekeepers can become its most dangerous saboteurs when cornered